

ROI & Equity Analysis

Institutional Diagnostic Report

Generated: July 09, 2026 | 2 institution(s) | Data release: College_Scorecard_Raw_Data_06032026

Every figure in this document is reproducible from a named column of a named U.S. Department of Education College Scorecard data file, is labeled with the academic year of its own source data, and is defined in the Methodology & Definitions appendix. Modeled (projected) figures are marked with an asterisk and open chart markers, and are never substituted for reported values. Every ROI figure is shown with the numerator and denominator that produce it.

Georgia Institute of Technology

UNITID 139755 | Release: College_Scorecard_Raw_Data_06032026 | As reported: 2024-25

4.23 HEADLINE ROI (as reported) = \$119,180 (median earnings, 2022-23) ÷ \$28,167 (Gross COA, 2024-25) Est. 2025-26 ROI (trend-projected COA): 4.08*	2,611 PELL HEADCOUNT (est., 13.9% of all undergrads) Pell completion gap: +7.6 pts (2024-25, FTFT cohort)
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*Modeled: last reported Gross COA extended by its own historical CAGR (see Methodology). Never a reported figure.

What an ROI of 4.23 means: the median graduate of Georgia Institute of Technology earns \$119,180 per year four years after completing -- 4.23 times the \$28,167 annual gross cost of attendance. Equivalently, one year of those median earnings covers 106% of the entire four-year gross sticker cost (~\$112,668); it would take about 0.95 years (~11 months) of median earnings to match the full four-year cost. This ratio is descriptive, not causal: it reflects who enrolls and what they study, not only what the institution adds. With an admission rate of 14.1%, part of the earnings figure reflects admissions selection rather than institutional effect.

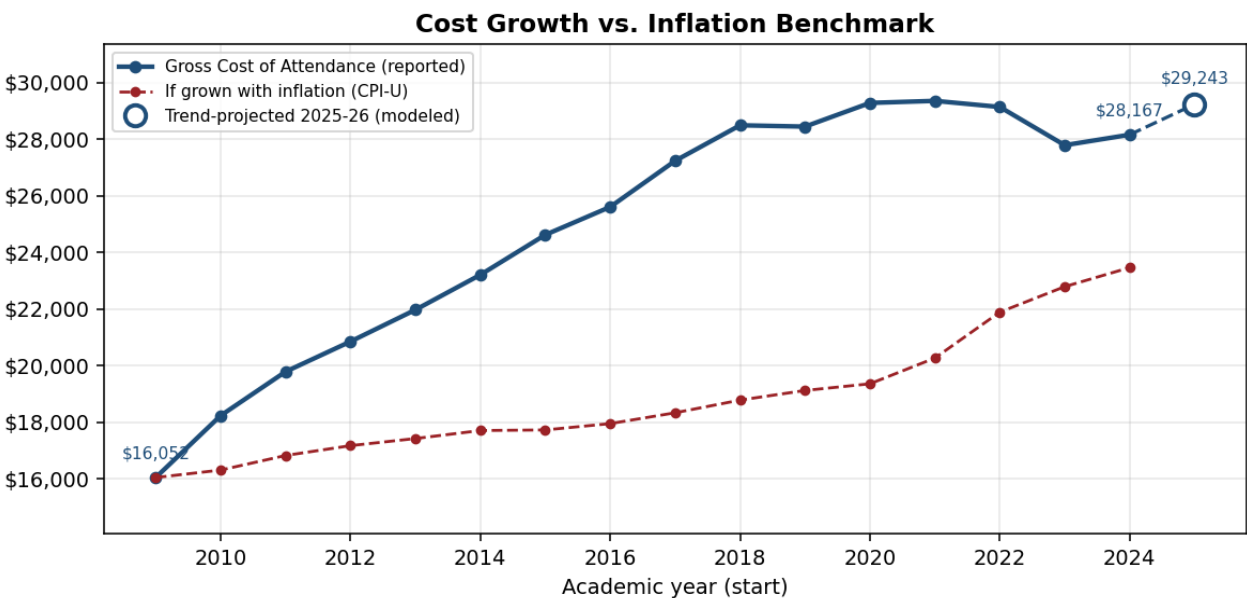
Executive Summary

Metric	Value (academic year)
Gross Cost of Attendance (as reported)	\$28,167 (2024-25)
Est. Gross COA, 2025-26 (modeled)*	\$29,243
Net Price (aided FT beginners)	\$12,116 (2024-25)
Median Earnings, 4yr after completion	\$119,180 (2022-23)
Graduation Rate (150%, FTFT cohort)	94.0% (2024-25)
Retention Rate (full-time)	98.1% (2024-25)
Cohort Default Rate (3-yr, latest mature cohort)	0.40% (2021-22)
Undergraduate Enrollment (UGDS)	18,785 (2024-25)

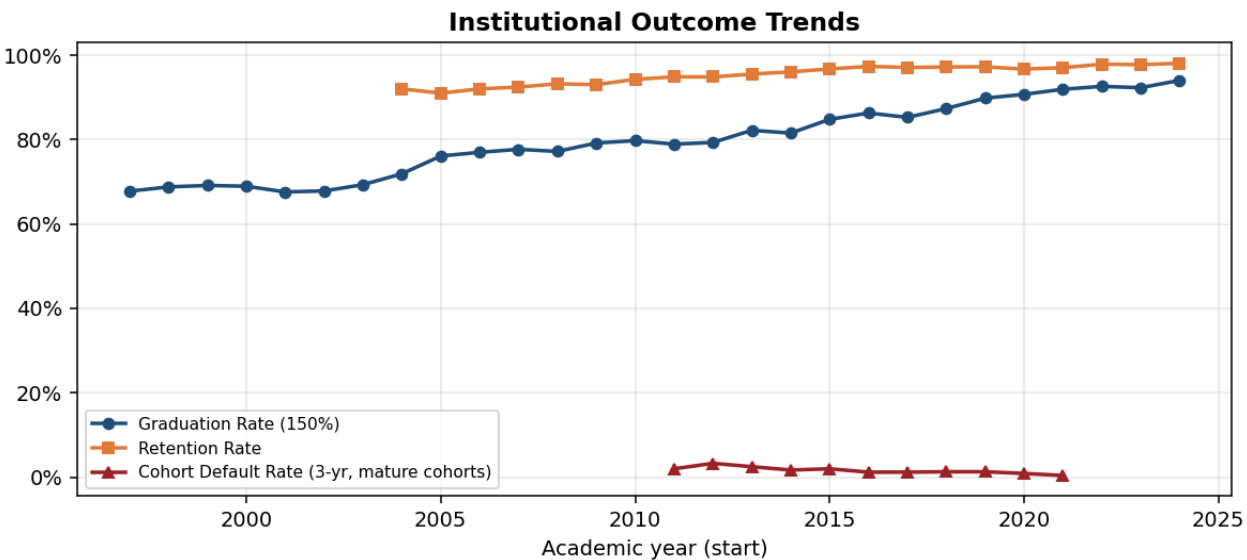
*Modeled. Each figure carries the academic year of its own source data; reporting lags differ by metric (see Methodology).

Note: Latest release reports 0.0000 for 2024-25, consistent with an immature cohort placeholder; the latest mature (non-zero) cohort is shown instead.

Georgia Institute of Technology: Cost Analysis

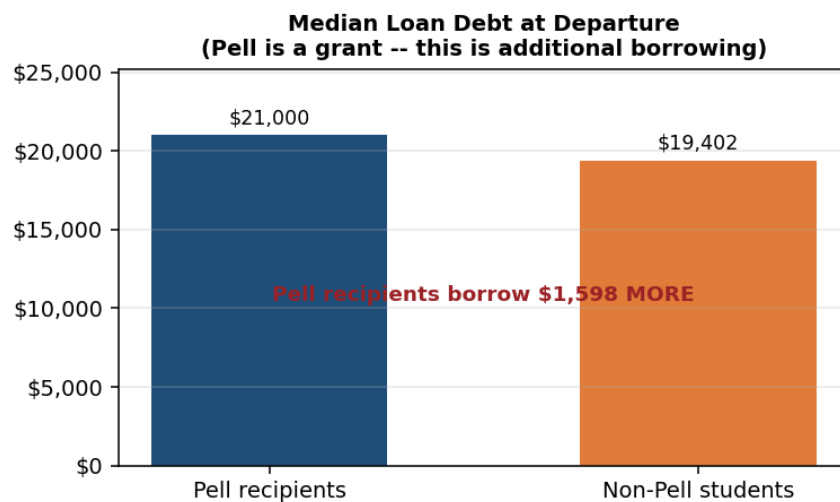
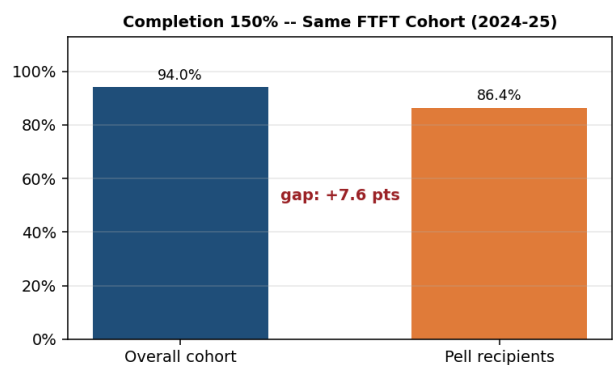
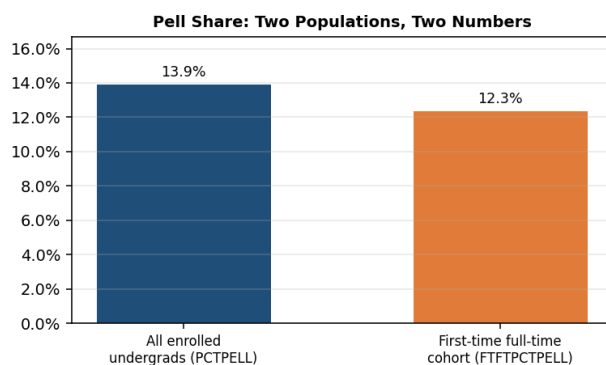


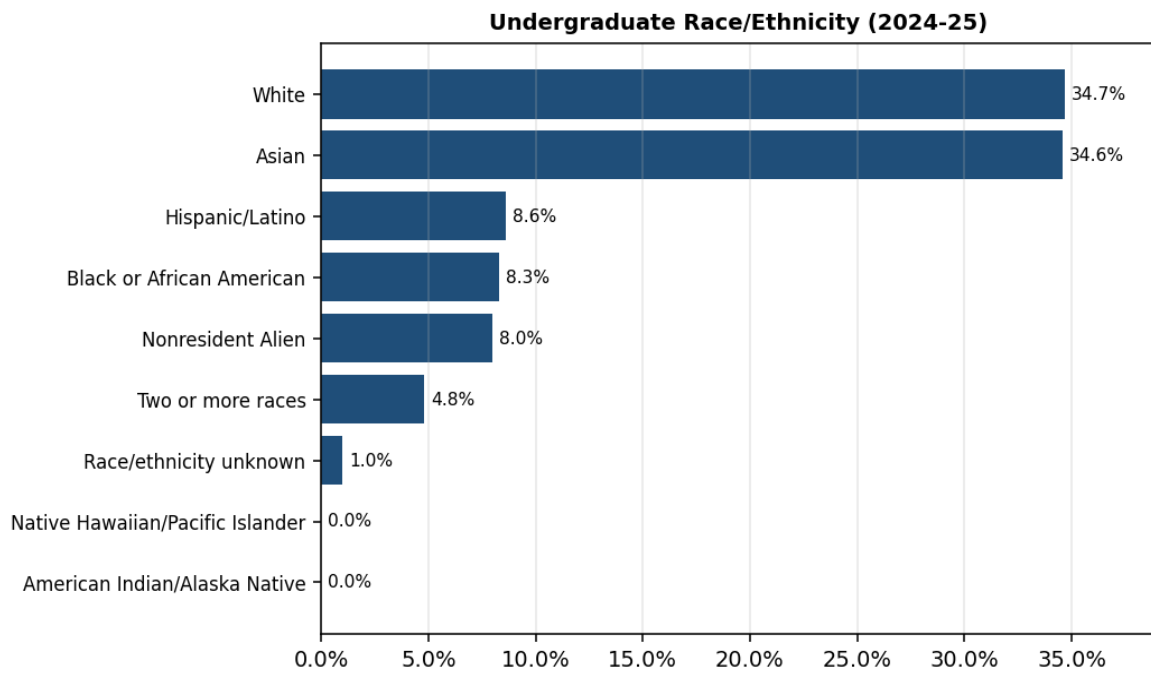
Solid/filled markers are reported COSTT4_A values; the open marker is the trend-projected (modeled) point.



Georgia Institute of Technology: Equity Analysis

13.9% of all enrolled undergraduates at Georgia Institute of Technology receive Pell Grants; within the entering first-time full-time cohort the share is 12.3% -- lower than the all-undergraduate figure, which is why this report never merges the two into one 'Pell rate'. Within the same first-time full-time cohort, Pell recipients complete at 86.4% versus 94.0% overall -- a gap of +7.6 percentage points (2024-25). Because both groups cleared the same admissions bar, this within-cohort gap cannot be attributed to admissions selectivity; it points to post-enrollment factors -- financial strain, work obligations, unmet need -- rather than admission standards. Despite Pell being grant aid, the median Pell recipient leaves with \$21,000 in loan debt -- \$1,598 MORE than the \$19,402 median for non-Pell students. The mechanism is unmet need: Pell tops out near \$7,400/year, and Pell eligibility itself signals a family with little capacity to cover the remaining net price in cash -- so the same residual bill a higher-income family pays out of pocket becomes a loan for a Pell recipient. Identical charge, different financing; only one shows up as debt. (Debt medians are among borrowers; composition effects such as independent-student status cannot be decomposed from this file.) Admission rate is 14.1% (2024-25); selectivity gates who can access these outcomes in the first place, so access and outcome figures should be read together.

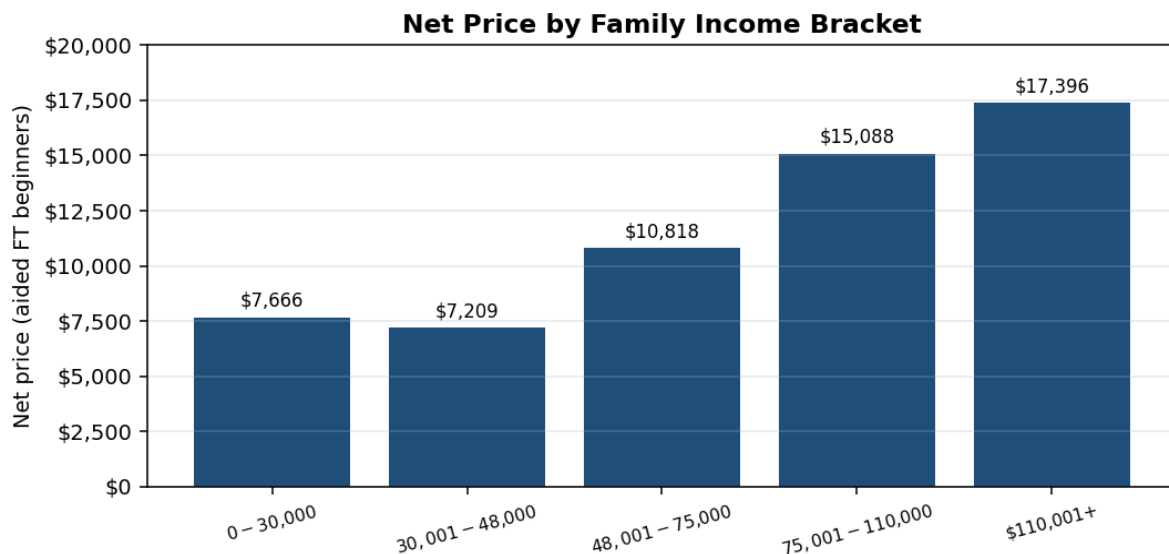




Shares may not sum to 100% due to rounding.

Income (Pell) and race/ethnicity dimensions only; first-generation status, disability, and other dimensions are not covered here.

Georgia Institute of Technology: Net Price by Family Income

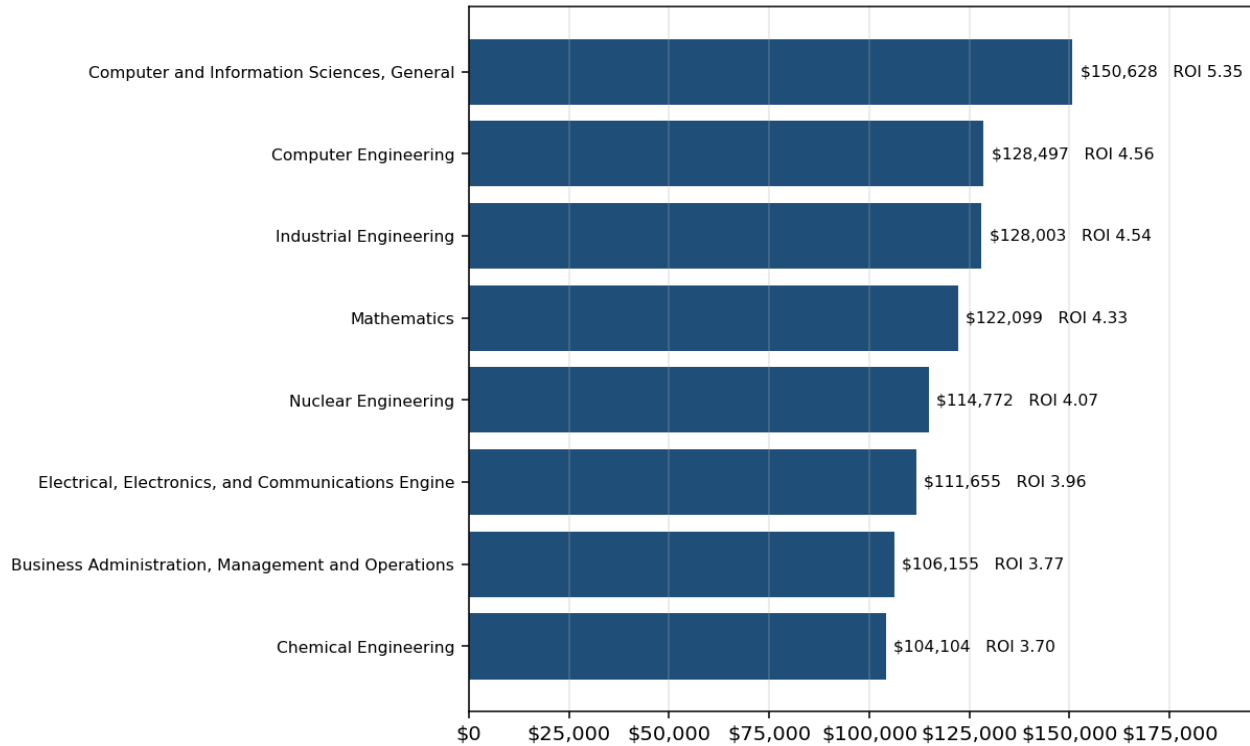


Aided full-time beginning undergraduates. Bracket dollar ranges are ED's own column definitions (NPT41-NPT45), not inferred.

What the slope means: net price rises with family income because grant aid is need-scaled -- the upward slope itself is aid design working as intended, not a finding. Two figures carry the interpretation. First, steepness: the top bracket pays 2.27x what the bottom bracket pays at Georgia Institute of Technology; the higher this ratio, the more progressively aid scales with need. Second, and more consequential, the bottom bracket's absolute level: a family in the \$0-\$30,000 bracket pays \$7,666 per year -- at least 26% of gross family income (using the bracket ceiling; families below it face a larger share), and 27% of the \$28,167 gross sticker cost after aid. Low-income affordability is set by aid depth, not by sticker price.

Georgia Institute of Technology: Programmatic ROI

Program Median Earnings (4yr after completion)
ROI = earnings / Gross COA \$28,167 (2024-25), same denominator for all



Program	Median Earnings (4yr)	ROI	Median Debt	Debt/Earnings
Computer and Information Sciences, General	\$150,628	5.35	\$20,500	0.14
Computer Engineering	\$128,497	4.56	\$20,000	0.16
Industrial Engineering	\$128,003	4.54	\$19,791	0.15
Mathematics	\$122,099	4.33	N/A	N/A
Nuclear Engineering	\$114,772	4.07	\$21,426	0.19
Electrical, Electronics, and Communications Engineering	\$111,655	3.96	\$22,250	0.20
Business Administration, Management and Operations	\$106,155	3.77	\$21,500	0.20
Chemical Engineering	\$104,104	3.70	\$26,250	0.25

Debt is median Stafford/Grad PLUS at completion, shown as its own ratio -- never folded into ROI (debt is financing, not cost).

Georgia Southern University

UNITID 139931 | Release: College_Scorecard_Raw_Data_06032026 | As reported: 2024-25

2.55 HEADLINE ROI (as reported) = \$62,342 (median earnings, 2022-23) ÷ \$24,430 (Gross COA, 2024-25) Est. 2025-26 ROI (trend-projected COA): 2.48*	7,899 PELL HEADCOUNT (est., 36.2% of all undergrads) Pell completion gap: +5.3 pts (2024-25, FTFT cohort)
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*Modeled: last reported Gross COA extended by its own historical CAGR (see Methodology). Never a reported figure.

What an ROI of 2.55 means: the median graduate of Georgia Southern University earns \$62,342 per year four years after completing -- 2.55 times the \$24,430 annual gross cost of attendance. Equivalently, one year of those median earnings covers 64% of the entire four-year gross sticker cost (~\$97,720); it would take about 1.57 years (~19 months) of median earnings to match the full four-year cost. This ratio is descriptive, not causal: it reflects who enrolls and what they study, not only what the institution adds. With an admission rate of 87.9%, part of the earnings figure reflects admissions selection rather than institutional effect.

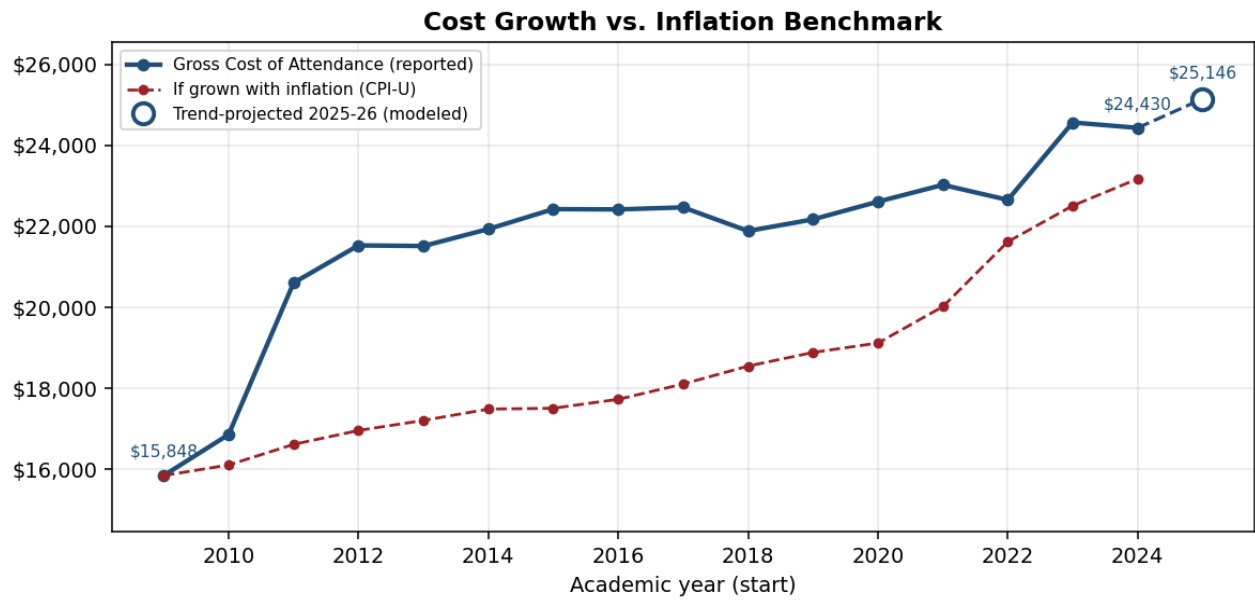
Executive Summary

Metric	Value (academic year)
Gross Cost of Attendance (as reported)	\$24,430 (2024-25)
Est. Gross COA, 2025-26 (modeled)*	\$25,146
Net Price (aided FT beginners)	\$15,267 (2024-25)
Median Earnings, 4yr after completion	\$62,342 (2022-23)
Graduation Rate (150%, FTFT cohort)	54.9% (2024-25)
Retention Rate (full-time)	77.8% (2024-25)
Cohort Default Rate (3-yr, latest mature cohort)	1.00% (2021-22)
Undergraduate Enrollment (UGDS)	21,790 (2024-25)

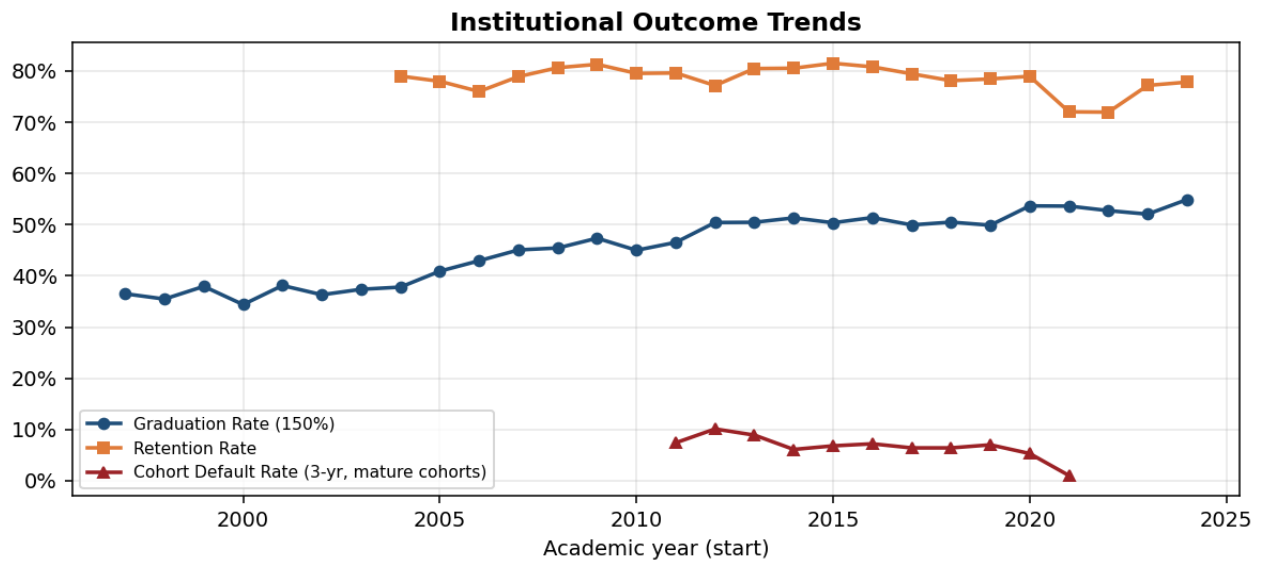
*Modeled. Each figure carries the academic year of its own source data; reporting lags differ by metric (see Methodology).

Note: Latest release reports 0.0000 for 2024-25, consistent with an immature cohort placeholder; the latest mature (non-zero) cohort is shown instead.

Georgia Southern University: Cost Analysis

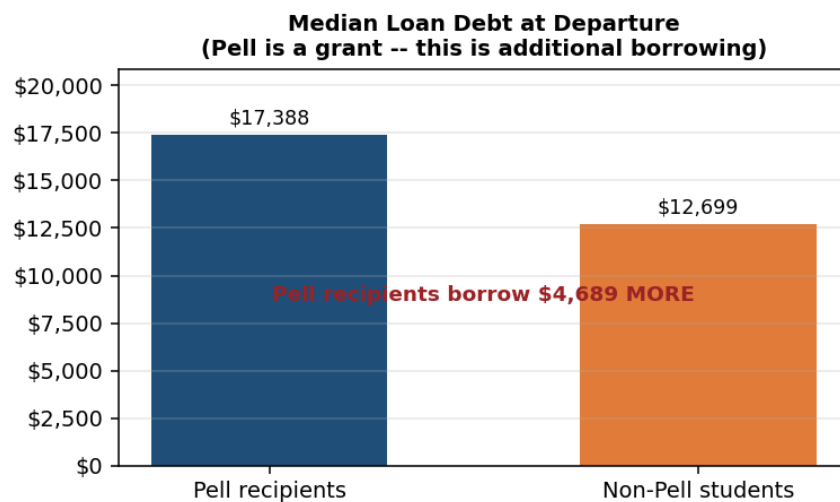
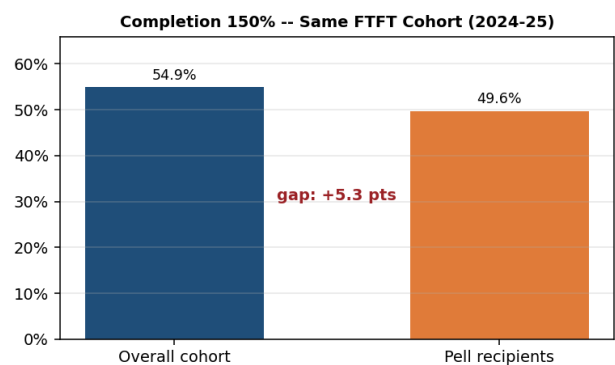
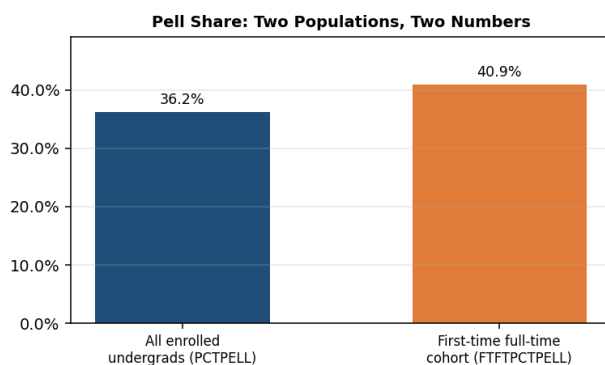


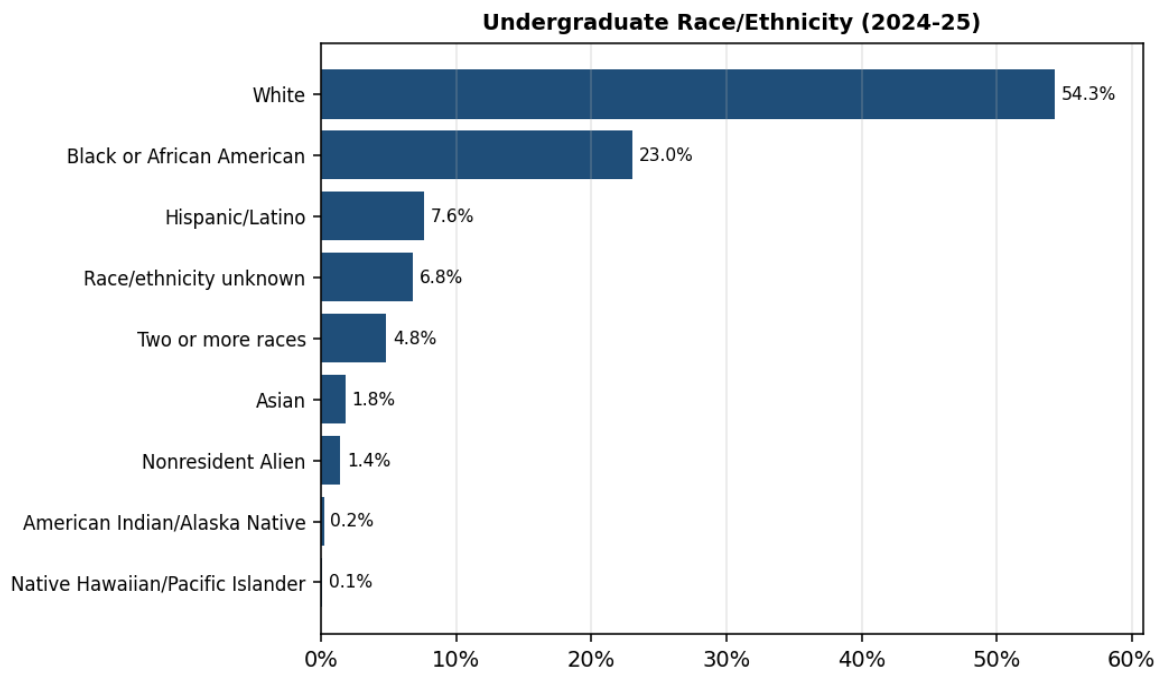
Solid/filled markers are reported COSTT4_A values; the open marker is the trend-projected (modeled) point.



Georgia Southern University: Equity Analysis

36.2% of all enrolled undergraduates at Georgia Southern University receive Pell Grants; within the entering first-time full-time cohort the share is 40.9% -- higher than the all-undergraduate figure, which is why this report never merges the two into one 'Pell rate'. Within the same first-time full-time cohort, Pell recipients complete at 49.6% versus 54.9% overall -- a gap of +5.3 percentage points (2024-25). Because both groups cleared the same admissions bar, this within-cohort gap cannot be attributed to admissions selectivity; it points to post-enrollment factors -- financial strain, work obligations, unmet need -- rather than admission standards. Despite Pell being grant aid, the median Pell recipient leaves with \$17,388 in loan debt -- \$4,689 MORE than the \$12,699 median for non-Pell students. The mechanism is unmet need: Pell tops out near \$7,400/year, and Pell eligibility itself signals a family with little capacity to cover the remaining net price in cash -- so the same residual bill a higher-income family pays out of pocket becomes a loan for a Pell recipient. Identical charge, different financing; only one shows up as debt. (Debt medians are among borrowers; composition effects such as independent-student status cannot be decomposed from this file.) Admission rate is 87.9% (2024-25); selectivity gates who can access these outcomes in the first place, so access and outcome figures should be read together.

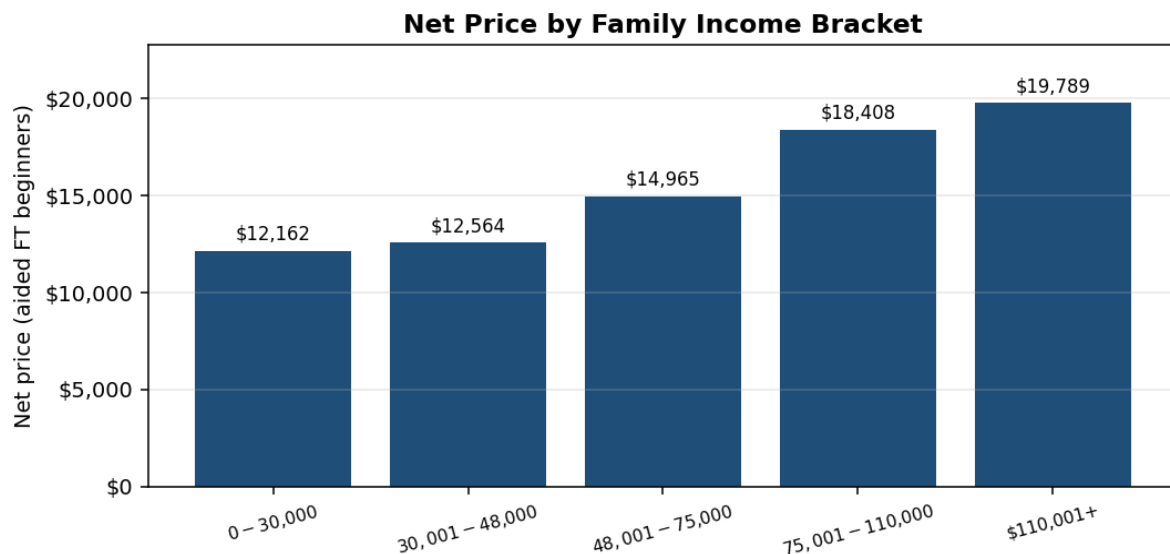




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Income (Pell) and race/ethnicity dimensions only; first-generation status, disability, and other dimensions are not covered here.

Georgia Southern University: Net Price by Family Income

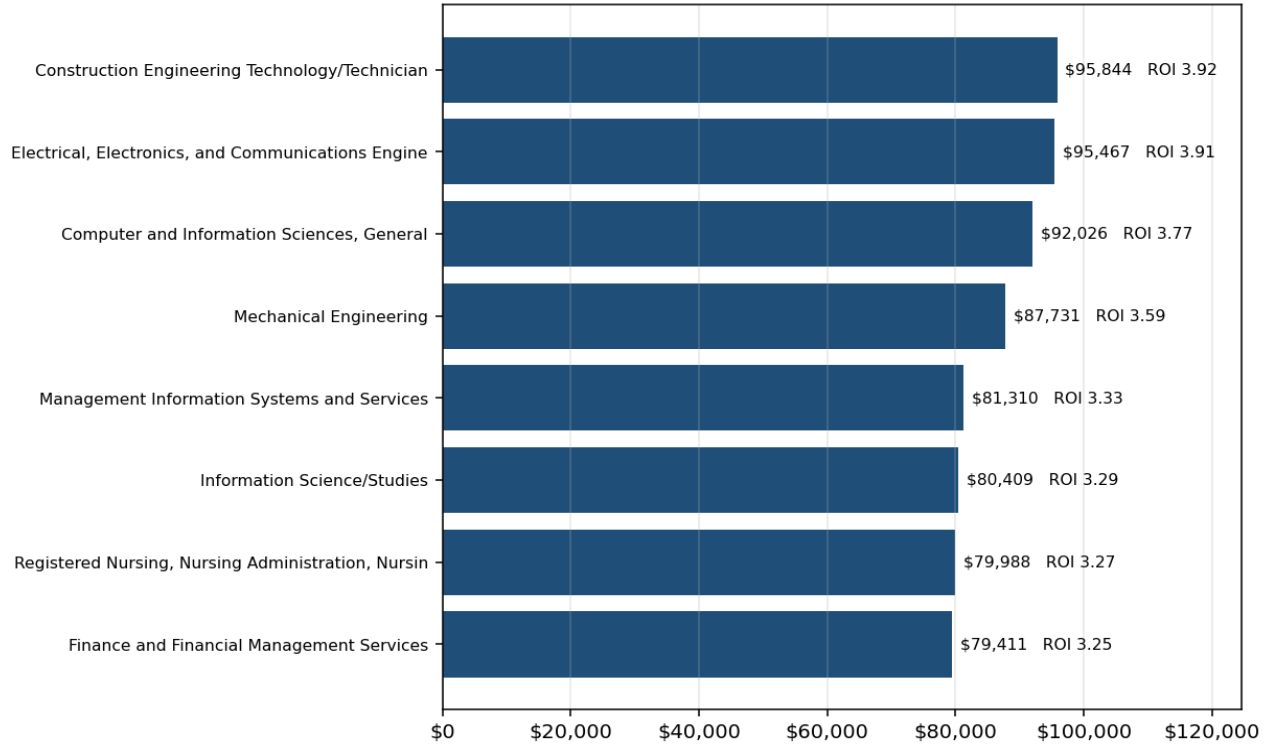


Aided full-time beginning undergraduates. Bracket dollar ranges are ED's own column definitions (NPT41-NPT45), not inferred.

What the slope means: net price rises with family income because grant aid is need-scaled -- the upward slope itself is aid design working as intended, not a finding. Two figures carry the interpretation. First, steepness: the top bracket pays 1.63x what the bottom bracket pays at Georgia Southern University; the higher this ratio, the more progressively aid scales with need. Second, and more consequential, the bottom bracket's absolute level: a family in the \$0-\$30,000 bracket pays \$12,162 per year -- at least 40% of gross family income (using the bracket ceiling; families below it face a larger share), and 50% of the \$24,430 gross sticker cost after aid. Low-income affordability is set by aid depth, not by sticker price.

Georgia Southern University: Programmatic ROI

Program Median Earnings (4yr after completion)
ROI = earnings / Gross COA \$24,430 (2024-25), same denominator for all



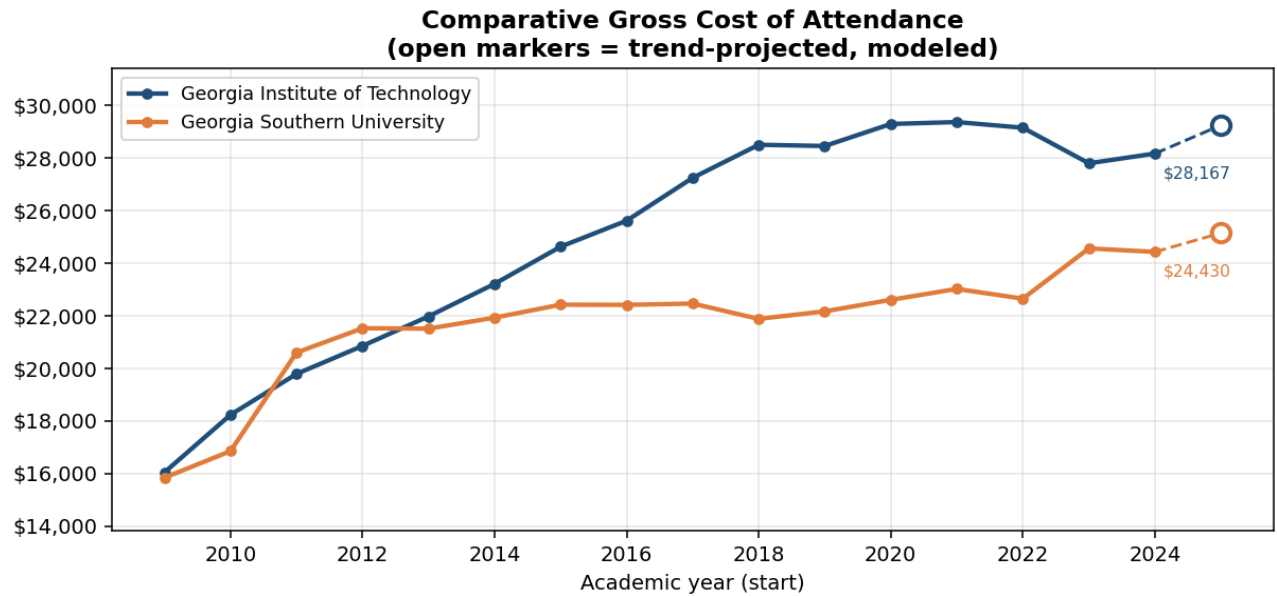
Program	Median Earnings (4yr)	ROI	Median Debt	Debt/Earnings
Construction Engineering Technology/Technician	\$95,844	3.92	\$24,225	0.25
Electrical, Electronics, and Communications Engineering	\$95,467	3.91	\$24,375	0.26
Computer and Information Sciences, General	\$92,026	3.77	\$23,125	0.25
Mechanical Engineering	\$87,731	3.59	\$23,125	0.26
Management Information Systems and Services	\$81,310	3.33	\$20,000	0.25
Information Science/Studies	\$80,409	3.29	\$26,000	0.32
Registered Nursing, Nursing Administration, Nursing Research and Clinical Nursing	\$79,988	3.27	\$24,000	0.30
Finance and Financial Management Services	\$79,411	3.25	\$22,000	0.28

Debt is median Stafford/Grad PLUS at completion, shown as its own ratio -- never folded into ROI (debt is financing, not cost).

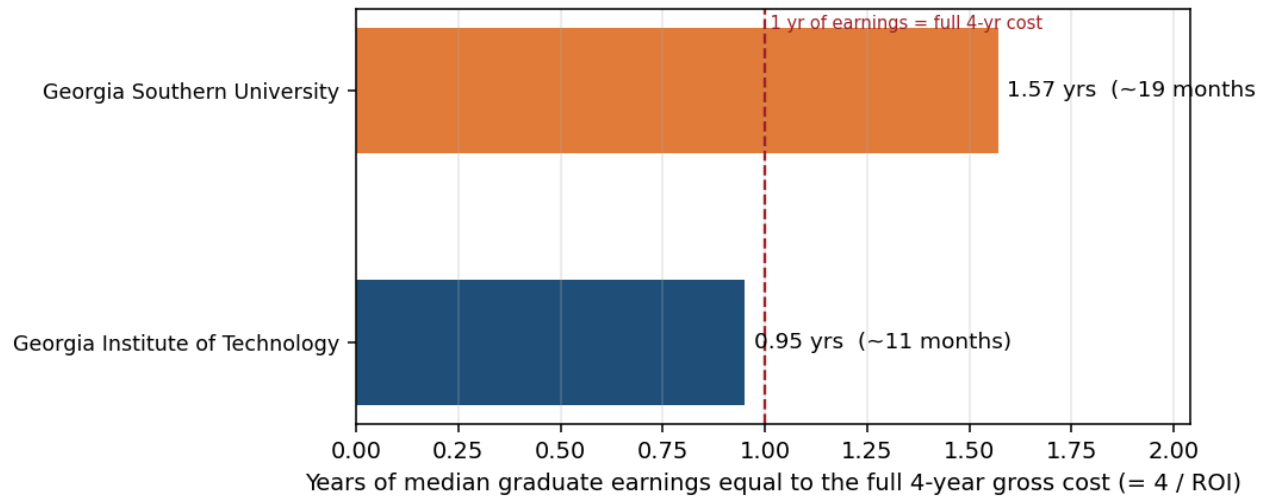
Comparative Analysis

Institution	Gross COA (reported)	Est. COA (modeled)*	Grad 150%	Pell % (all UG)	Pell Headcount	ROI (reported)	ROI (modeled)*
Georgia Institute of Technology	\$28,167	\$29,243	94.0%	13.9%	2,611	4.23	4.08
Georgia Southern University	\$24,430	\$25,146	54.9%	36.2%	7,899	2.55	2.48

*Modeled columns are trend projections, never reported values.



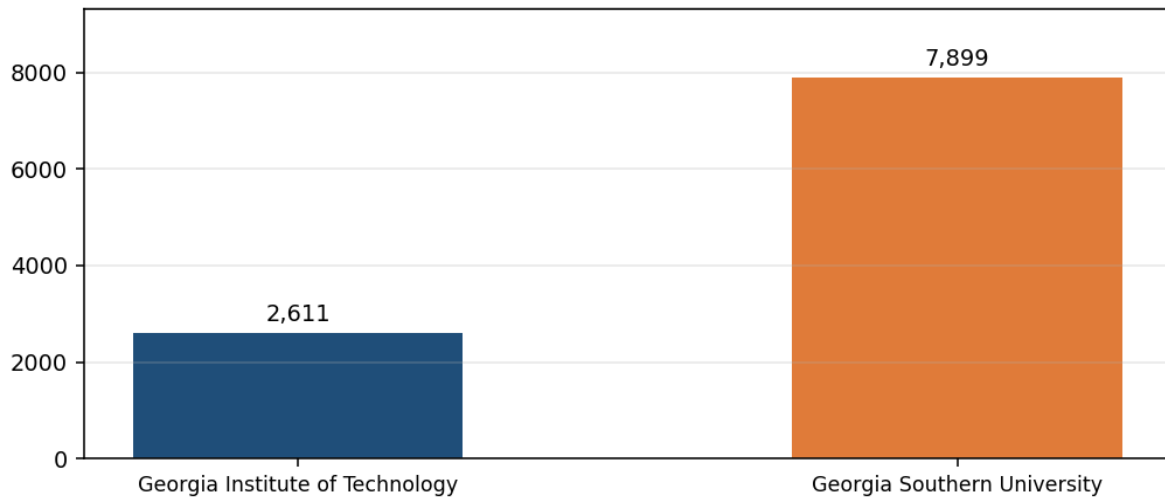
**What the ROI Ratio Means in Time:
Years of Earnings to Match a Full 4-Year Gross Cost**



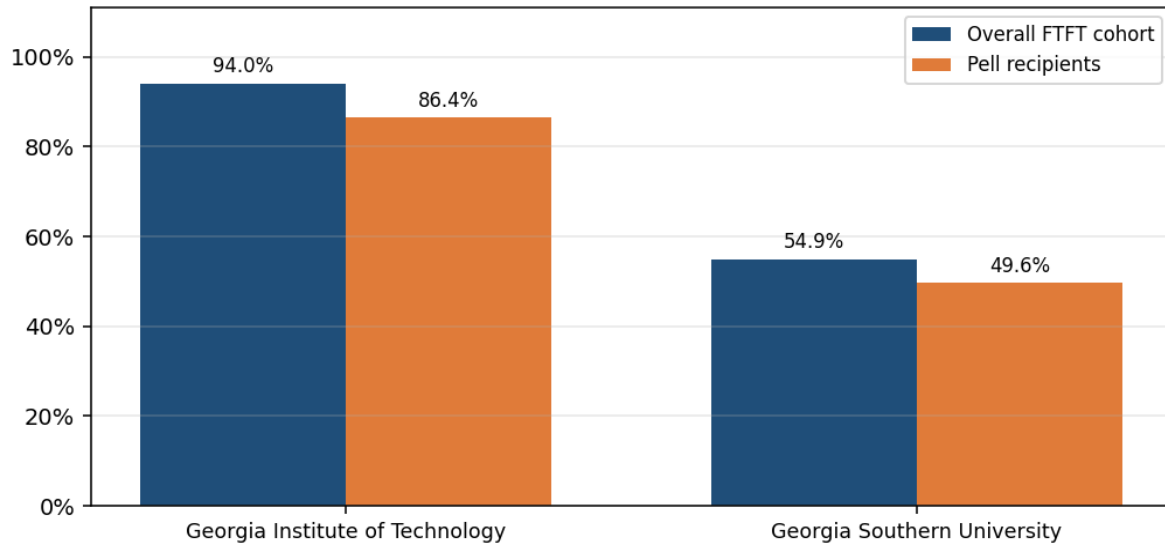
Derived from the same two inputs as ROI (years = $4 / \text{ROI}$); a shorter bar means earnings tower further over cost. Gross (pre-aid) cost basis; descriptive, not causal.

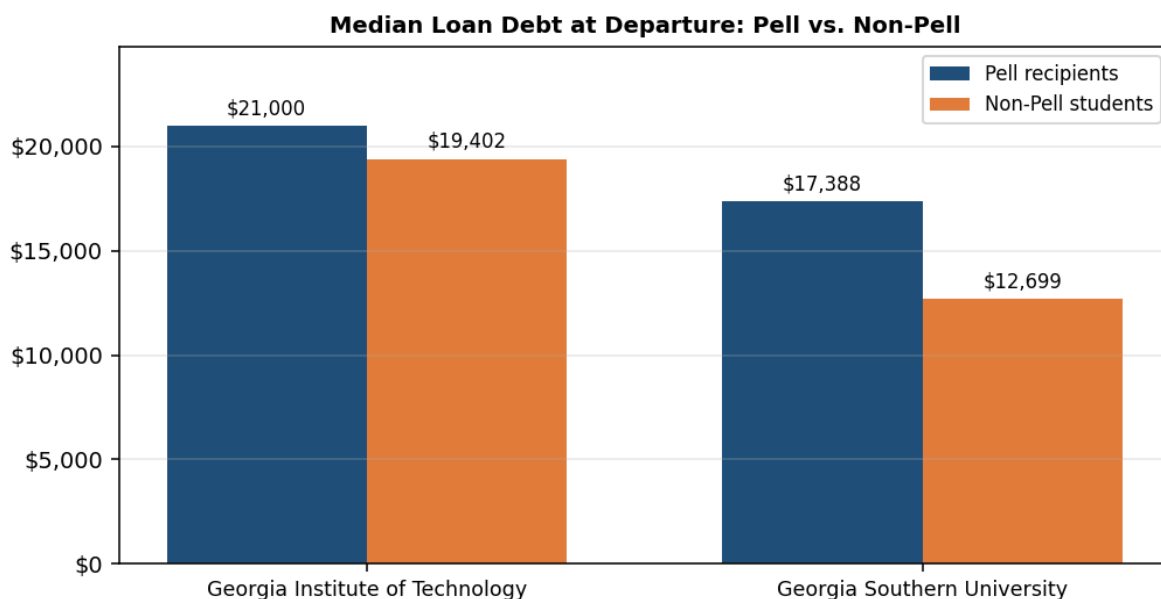
Equity Comparison

**Estimated Pell Student Headcount
(all-undergrad Pell share x enrollment)**



Completion (150%): Overall vs. Pell, Same Cohort





Median federal loan debt at departure. Pell is a grant and carries no debt; this compares additional borrowing by Pell recipients against non-Pell students -- a gap here means the lowest-income students leave with MORE debt despite grant aid.

Interpreting the Equity Comparison

The across-school pattern is not evidence about Pell students. In this sample the higher-Pell institution (Georgia Southern University, 36.2% Pell) has the lower completion rate (54.9% vs. 94.0%), mirroring a well-documented national association. But with two institutions this is one observation, not a correlation -- and even at scale, the pattern is confounded by admissions selectivity, academic preparation correlated with family income, per-student resources, and program mix. Inferring individual-level conclusions from institution-level patterns is the ecological fallacy; the within-cohort gaps on each institution's own page are the defensible evidence, because there both groups cleared the same admissions bar.

'Better for Pell students' has two defensible answers. By PARITY, Georgia Southern University's Pell students trail their own classmates by less (+5.3 vs. +7.6 points). By ABSOLUTE outcome, Georgia Institute of Technology's Pell completion rate (86.4%) exceeds even the OVERALL rate at the other institution (54.9%). Which standard matters -- equal outcomes within a campus, or higher outcomes across campuses -- is a value judgment this report surfaces rather than settles.

The affordability inversion. Georgia Institute of Technology has the higher sticker cost (\$28,167 vs. \$24,430), yet its poorest families (\$0-\$30,000 bracket) pay LESS: \$7,666 versus \$12,162 -- 26% versus 40% of a \$30,000 gross income. Sticker-price ordering INVERTS at the bottom bracket: for low-income families, aid depth -- not list price -- determines what college costs.

Where disadvantage compounds. At Georgia Southern University, the lowest-income students pay the higher bottom-bracket net price, borrow \$4,689 more than non-Pell peers, and complete at 49.6% -- pay more, borrow more, finish less. Yet the same institution provides access at 3.0x the Pell headcount of its comparator. Broad access and compounding burden coexist here -- that tension, not either half of it alone, is the finding.

Overall Conclusion

By the as-reported ROI ratio (median earnings ÷ Gross Cost of Attendance), **Georgia Institute of Technology** ranks highest at 4.23.

Under the modeled (trend-projected COA) ROI, **Georgia Institute of Technology** also ranks highest, at 4.08.

By raw access -- estimated Pell student headcount -- **Georgia Southern University** ranks highest at 7,899 students.

Why the ratios differ: Georgia Institute of Technology's ROI (4.23) is 1.7x Georgia Southern University's (2.55). Decomposing the two inputs: Georgia Institute of Technology's graduates earn 91% more, while its gross cost is only 15% higher -- the ROI gap is driven almost entirely by the earnings side, not by price. In time terms, 0.95 years of median earnings match Georgia Institute of Technology's full four-year gross cost, versus 1.57 years at Georgia Southern University.

What the ratio does NOT say: Georgia Institute of Technology admits 14% of applicants versus 88% at Georgia Southern University. A large share of the earnings difference therefore reflects who clears the admissions bar and the program mix they study, not a measured institutional effect -- this ratio has no counterfactual and cannot separate selection from value added. Meanwhile Georgia Southern University serves 7,899 Pell students to Georgia Institute of Technology's 2,611 -- broad access and a high earnings ratio are, in this sample, features of different institutions.

These are different institutions. That divergence is the central finding: the institution scoring best on a simple earnings-to-cost ratio is not the one serving the most low-income students in absolute terms. A ranking built on either metric alone would give an incomplete picture of value and access.

ROI and equity are reported as separate, independently computed figures rather than one blended score; a single weighted number would embed a normative judgment about the relative importance of cost-efficiency versus access that this analysis leaves to the reader. This mirrors how the field's own equity-focused extensions (Third Way's Economic Mobility Index; the Postsecondary Value Commission framework) treat mobility as a distinct dimension rather than folding it into financial return.

This sample includes 2 institution(s); comparative visuals show individual data points, not statistically meaningful trends.

Methodology & Definitions

Gross Cost of Attendance (COSTT4_A)

The U.S. Department of Education's own computed average annual cost of attendance for the academic year (tuition, fees, books/supplies, and living costs), as published in the College Scorecard institution-level data files. This report reads ED's blended figure directly rather than reconstructing cost from separate tuition and room-and-board components. An earlier version of this pipeline performed that reconstruction and selected whichever reported living arrangement was most expensive each year; because the selected category could switch between years, that method manufactured a spurious one-year -14% cost 'cliff' for one institution. Reading COSTT4_A eliminates that class of error.

Net Price

Average annual cost minus federal, state/local, and institutional grant or scholarship aid, for full-time beginning undergraduates who received such aid (NPT4_PUB for public institutions, NPT4_PRIV for private). It is NOT tuition, NOT the sticker price, and does not represent what non-aided, part-time, or transfer students pay.

Institutional ROI Index

Median earnings (MD_EARN_WNE_4YR: median earnings of graduates four years after completion) divided by Gross Cost of Attendance. The SAME formula is used for every ROI figure in this report, institution-level and program-level. It is a raw earnings-to-cost ratio: unlike published ROI models (Third Way's price-to-earnings premium, FREOPP's lifetime-earnings model, the Bipartisan Policy Center's ROI calculator), it does NOT net out counterfactual earnings (what a comparable person would earn without the degree), does NOT account for opportunity cost of years spent enrolled, and has no time dimension. Those three published models -- despite incorporating such adjustments -- disagree with one another by 25+ percentage points on the share of for-profit institutions with positive ROI (Third Way 77.4% vs. BPC 51.7%), which illustrates why this report favors a simple, fully reproducible ratio over a more elaborate but assumption-laden estimate. Read it as a rough comparative indicator, not a validated financial return.

Trend-Projected Gross COA (modeled)

The last as-reported COSTT4_A value extended forward by that series' own compound annual growth rate (CAGR) to the current academic year. A trend continuation, not a forecast: it assumes whatever drove past growth continues unchanged. Every appearance of this figure is labeled 'modeled'; it is never silently substituted for a reported value.

Years-of-Earnings Equivalent (derived)

Years of median graduate earnings equal to the full four-year gross cost of attendance: $(4 \times \text{annual Gross COA}) / \text{median earnings}$, which is algebraically $4 / \text{ROI}$. Provided purely as an interpretation aid -- it contains no information beyond the ROI ratio itself, but restates it in units of time. It uses GROSS (pre-aid) cost, assumes a four-year program, ignores taxes, living costs, and foregone earnings while enrolled, and is descriptive, not causal.

CAGR (Compound Annual Growth Rate)

$((\text{Current} / \text{Historical}) ^ {1 / \text{Years Elapsed}}) - 1$. Used instead of a flat percent change so that series with different reporting lags are compared on equal footing.

Graduation Rate (150%)

C150_4: share of first-time, full-time bachelor's-degree-seeking students who complete within 150% of normal time (six years). The cohort year shown is the reporting year of the data file; the underlying entering cohort began approximately six years earlier.

Pell vs. Non-Pell Completion Gap

C150_4 (overall) minus C150_4_PELL (Pell recipients), in percentage points. Both rates describe the SAME first-time, full-time cohort, so the comparison is population-matched. A positive gap means Pell recipients complete at a lower rate

than the cohort overall.

Pell Grant Recipient Share -- two measures

PCTPELL is the share of ALL enrolled undergraduates receiving Pell (the access/scale measure, used for the headcount estimate). FTFTPCTPELL is the share of the first-time, full-time entering cohort receiving Pell (the measure whose population matches the completion-gap cohort). They are different populations and can differ by several points; this report shows both, labeled, rather than merging them.

Median Loan Debt, Pell Recipients (PELL_DEBT_MDN)

Median federal loan debt at departure among Pell recipients who borrowed. Pell itself is a grant and carries no debt; this measures how much Pell recipients additionally borrow beyond what grants cover, against NOPELL_DEBT_MDN for students who never received Pell. A positive Pell-minus-non-Pell gap is a direct measure of unmet need being financed as loans: the maximum Pell award (~\$7,400/year) covers only part of net price, and Pell eligibility itself signals limited family capacity to pay the remainder in cash -- so the residual a higher-income family pays out of pocket becomes debt for a low-income one. Medians are computed among borrowers; composition effects (independent status, time to degree) cannot be decomposed from this file.

Net Price Progressivity Ratio (derived)

Top income bracket's net price divided by the bottom bracket's. Pure algebra on the published bracket values, provided as an interpretation aid: a higher ratio means grant aid scales more steeply with need. It says nothing about the ABSOLUTE burden on low-income families, which the following figure addresses.

Lowest-Bracket Affordability Burden (derived)

Bottom-bracket (\$0-\$30,000) net price divided by the \$30,000 bracket ceiling -- a conservative LOWER BOUND on the share of gross family income the poorest aided families pay per year (families earning below the ceiling face a larger share). Because this uses aid-adjusted net price, it can invert sticker-price orderings between institutions: the school with the higher list price can be the cheaper school for its poorest students.

Cohort Default Rate (3-year, CDR3)

Share of a borrower cohort defaulting within three years of entering repayment. The newest release years carry 0.0000 placeholders for cohorts that have not yet aged into a full three-year window; this report shows the latest mature (non-zero) cohort and labels its year.

Retention Rate (RET_FT4)

Share of first-time, full-time bachelor's-seeking students who return for a second year.

Known Limitations

- All data come from the U.S. Department of Education College Scorecard institution-level and field-of-study flat files (single release, date-stamped in each institution's header). No live scraping and no third-party API are used; every figure is reproducible from the named column of the named file.
- The newest academic year present in a release is typically unpopulated; 'as reported' therefore refers to the latest year in which each field actually carries a value (currently 2024-25 for cost and completion metrics), not the calendar date of this report.
- Different metrics carry different reporting lags (e.g., earnings lag cost by roughly two years; CDR3 lags further due to cohort maturation). Each figure is labeled with its own academic year rather than forced onto a single 'data year'.
- The Institutional ROI Index is a raw earnings-to-cost ratio, not an earnings-premium model. It does not control for selection (which students an institution admits), does not establish causation between attendance and earnings, and does not account for opportunity cost.

- All cost figures reflect a standard academic-year structure. Summer-term enrollment and costs are not incorporated, which can materially affect annualized totals for students who attend year-round.
- Program-level earnings and debt reflect graduates only, not all enrollees, and are drawn from the most recent cohort ED reports. Small programs may be suppressed for privacy ('PrivacySuppressed'); suppressed values are treated as missing, never as zero.
- Equity coverage is limited to income (Pell) and race/ethnicity dimensions available in the source files; first-generation status, disability, and other dimensions are not covered.
- This sample includes only the institutions listed. Comparative and scatter-style visuals show individual data points, not statistically meaningful trends.

Data Sources & Citations

U.S. Department of Education College Scorecard -- Institution-Level Data Files (MERGED1996_97 through current release). All institution-level metrics: cost of attendance, net price, tuition, completion and retention rates, Pell shares, cohort default rates, median earnings, enrollment, demographics, admission rate, median debt. <https://collegescorecard.ed.gov/data>

U.S. Department of Education College Scorecard -- Field-of-Study Data File (Most-Recent-Cohorts-Field-of-Study). Program-level median earnings and median loan debt by CIP code and credential level. <https://collegescorecard.ed.gov/data>

College Scorecard Data Dictionary (data.yaml, bundled with each release). Authoritative field definitions used to select and label every column read by this pipeline.

Bipartisan Policy Center: 'Measuring the Return on Investment of Higher Education' (Wielk & Stein, 2024). Comparison of Third Way, FREOPP, and BPC ROI models; cited in the Institutional ROI Index definition regarding cross-model disagreement and this report's rationale for a simple transparent ratio.

U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics -- Consumer Price Index (CPI-U). Annual averages used for the inflation benchmark line in the cost trend chart. <https://www.bls.gov/cpi/>